

Still, I look back on those years at Safeway as one of the most enjoyable times of my life. Sure, the work wasn't very stimulating, but I got the feeling that I was part of a bigger team, and I made friendships that I still have to this day.

Even better, I can remember my very first payday, tearing open the dot-matrix-printed payslip and then rushing to the ATM to see if my money had been deposited.

Finally, I had freedom—I was earning my own money.

I used that money to restore a car (which I thought would help me with girls . . . but didn't).

I used it to go on holidays when I finished school (with my mates . . . no girls).

And I used it to kickstart compound interest (badly at first, but that's another adventure).

What's more, I have never felt wealthier than I did that day. And it'll be the same for your teen when they get that first job.

There's only one challenge: you're going to have to do some work yourself to make it happen.

Parents: Would you like fries with that?

Like I said, I've been talking to some of the top tacos at the big employers lately, including the head of HR at Maccas, Jennifer St Ledger.

She totally gets it: 'We're employing the parents just as much as the teenager,' she told me.

'After all, they're the ones who wash the uniforms, and who wait in their car at night for their shift to finish.'

I agree.

And that's why I'm talking to you right now.